



Discussion Guide: Ted Smith

Reckless Love: Living for Things That Die

Reflect

- Ted opens with a story about a church he pastored that has since closed, with the building being sold to an organization called Winner's Circle. Have you ever been a part of a church or other organization that has shut its doors? If so, describe the situation and how it affected you.
- Ted argues that for love to be genuine, it must be reckless. What makes love "reckless?"
- Ted notes that most Mainline churches are in "decline," and many of their strategies are designed to keep them "alive." Based on his talk, what is the fundamental flaw with this approach? What does it misunderstand about the nature of God and the nature of God's people?

Respond

- What would "reckless love" look like in your homes and families? In your church? In your neighborhood and places of work?
- Ted closes with the statement that reckless love – by its uncalculating nature – is costly. When have you felt the sort of cost of love that he describes?
- What would need to change in your life in order to demonstrate reckless love? What would your church or community of worship need to sacrifice in order to demonstrate a love with no consideration for gain of any kind?